

Rhetorical technique - Workbook 3

Focused practice - Workbook 3 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each text closely. Decide what relationship the question is testing before looking at the options. After checking the key, explain why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Before you start

- Use the surrounding text, not one isolated keyword.
- Prefer precise relationship words such as illustrates, qualifies, contrasts, supports, or results in.
- Do not accept an answer that merely summarizes when the question asks about function or effect.

Public Pool

"Not next year. Not after another study. This summer," the editorial says about repairing the public pool.

1. Which rhetorical technique is most important in this example?

- A. repetition and short sentences
- B. a definition used only to introduce vocabulary
- C. a chronological list of unrelated events
- D. a neutral transition with no rhetorical effect

2. What does the technique accomplish in this text?

- A. It proves a broader claim that the example cannot establish.
- B. The repeated "not" and abrupt final phrase create urgency around the timing of repairs.
- C. It changes the topic instead of developing the writer's point.
- D. It adds decoration without affecting emphasis, clarity, or persuasion.

Data Dashboard

A budget proposal includes a chart showing emergency-call response times over five years, with the most recent year highlighted.

3. Which rhetorical technique is most important in this example?

- A. a definition used only to introduce vocabulary
- B. a chronological list of unrelated events
- C. data visualization
- D. a neutral transition with no rhetorical effect

4. What does the technique accomplish in this text?

- A. It proves a broader claim that the example cannot establish.
- B. It changes the topic instead of developing the writer's point.
- C. It adds decoration without affecting emphasis, clarity, or persuasion.
- D. The chart lets readers see the trend quickly and focuses attention on the current result.

School Breakfast

An article contrasts a nearly empty breakfast room at 7:15 a.m. with a busy grab-and-go cart placed near the main entrance at 7:45.

5. Which rhetorical technique is most important in this example?

- A. contrast
- B. a definition used only to introduce vocabulary
- C. a chronological list of unrelated events
- D. a neutral transition with no rhetorical effect

6. What does the technique accomplish in this text?

- A. It proves a broader claim that the example cannot establish.
- B. The before-and-after comparison emphasizes how changing location and timing increased access.
- C. It changes the topic instead of developing the writer's point.
- D. It adds decoration without affecting emphasis, clarity, or persuasion.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. The writer uses repetition and short sentences.
2. B. The repeated "not" and abrupt final phrase create urgency around the timing of repairs.
3. C. The writer uses data visualization.
4. D. The chart lets readers see the trend quickly and focuses attention on the current result.
5. A. The writer uses contrast.
6. B. The before-and-after comparison emphasizes how changing location and timing increased access.

Mistake review

- If you summarized instead of explaining a relationship, label it summary-not-function.
- If you chose a transition or structure because of one keyword, label it one-clue trap.
- If you confused a quoted perspective with the author's own view, label it viewpoint source.
- If you named a rhetorical device but missed what it achieves, label it effect missed.
- Redo missed questions later without looking at the key.